

SHIWEI LIAO

Doctoral Applicant | Media & Communication | Generative AI | Communicative Authority | Digital Intermediation
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RESEARCH PROFILE

University of Melbourne Master of Global Media Communication graduate (WAM 80.38) researching how generative AI reshapes the communicative role and authority of digital intermediaries. My work connects media and communication, AI & society, platform governance, and critical interface research, with a current focus on generative AI learning platforms and platformed pedagogical authority.

EDUCATION

Master of Global Media Communication

2023 - 2025

The University of Melbourne, Faculty of Arts - Melbourne, Australia

- WAM 80.38 (H1); completed July 2025. Minor Thesis: *Governing via AI Broadcasting in the Digital Era* - 87/100 (H1), approximately 12,750 words; supervised by Dr Wilfred Wang.
- Used Fairclough's critical discourse analysis and NVivo-assisted coding to examine how Chinese AI policy and CCTV's 2024 AI Gala construct technological legitimacy and state-media authority, establishing my broader interest in AI-mediated institutional voice, legitimacy and authority.
- Selected H1 results: Global Communication: Theory & Research (88); Media and Communications Thesis (87); Media Convergence and Digital Culture (86); Digital Politics (85); Researching Audiences and Reception (85).

Bachelor of Broadcast Announcing and Anchoring Art

2017 - 2022

Communication University of Zhejiang - Hangzhou, China

- Cumulative average 87.42/100. Training combined broadcast presentation, interviewing, media production and communication practice, providing an early foundation in institutional voice and mediated public communication.

SELECTED AWARDS

- Zhejiang Provincial Government Scholarship.
- First-class Scholarship, Communication University of Zhejiang.
- Outstanding Award, National Innovation and Entrepreneurship Programme for College Students (Yi Shu Yi Ying project).

PROPOSED DOCTORAL RESEARCH DIRECTION

Generative AI, Digital Intermediation and Communicative Authority

- **Core question:** How does generative AI reshape the communicative role and authority of digital intermediaries?
- Proposed doctoral case: Using Doubao Aixue as its empirical site, the project examines how communicative authority is constructed through knowledge interpretation, feedback, error diagnosis, learning sequencing, course organisation and teacher-like interaction, and whether these practices amount to a broader form of platformed pedagogical authority.
- Media and communication contribution: Examines how communicative authority is constructed as generative AI platforms move from distributing information toward interpreting knowledge, organising learning, and assuming roles associated with educators and educational institutions.

METHODS & RESEARCH SKILLS

- **Established:** critical discourse analysis; qualitative content analysis; semi-structured interviewing; NVivo-assisted coding; keyword-frequency/co-occurrence analysis; corpus organisation.
- Current methodological development: walkthrough method; qualitative interface analysis; platform discourse analysis; longitudinal interface documentation.

SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

Doubao Aixue: Platformed Pedagogical Authority

Current research pilot

Conducting exploratory walkthrough and interface research on Doubao Aixue, examining how AI-generated explanations, feedback, error diagnosis, learning pathways and interactive classroom features construct teacher-like communicative authority and may contribute to a broader form of platformed pedagogical authority.

Seeing the City Through AI Glasses

Media Convergence and Digital Culture - 86/100, H1

Analysed AI smart glasses as wearable urban media infrastructure, extending my research from institutional AI discourse toward interfaces, media infrastructures and body-space-data relations.

Media Marketing and Crisis Discourse on TikTok

Researching Media & Communications - 80/100, H1

Compared BBC and Guardian coverage of TikTok's data-privacy crisis through qualitative content analysis and NVivo-assisted coding, demonstrating training in platform crisis discourse, media framing and qualitative coding.

Navigating the Privacy Paradox: TikTok's Role in the Digital Public Sphere

Researching Audiences and Reception - 85/100, H1

Used semi-structured interviewing and framing theory to examine how algorithmic curation shapes privacy perception, providing direct qualitative interviewing experience relevant to platform governance research.

MANUSCRIPT IN DEVELOPMENT

From AI Gala to Spring Festival Gala: The Infrastructuralisation of AI Discourse in Chinese State Media

In preparation

Article manuscript extending the minor thesis by examining how AI shifts from a visible object of technological legitimation to an embedded production condition in Chinese state-media ritual.

RELEVANT PROFESSIONAL & TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Online Test Preparation Instructor (IELTS and PTE)

2023 - present

Freelance / Online

- Deliver one-to-one and small-group online instruction, including lesson planning, formative feedback, speaking and writing support, and individual learning guidance.
- Provides sustained teaching and student-support experience relevant to future university tutoring and sessional teaching.

Freelance Short-form Video Producer

2021 - 2023

Independent client work - China

- Sourced small-business clients independently and produced promotional short-form video content for Douyin, from concept development and client communication to on-location shooting and post-production editing.
- Applied end-to-end multimedia skills developed through broadcast training, including field interviewing, copy/script preparation, visual storytelling, shooting, presenting/voice work where required, and editing.

Media and Communications Intern

2018 - 2019

Hangzhou TV Group / Anji News Group - Hangzhou and Anji, China

- Conducted on-location public interviews and supported live-broadcast, short-video and media-production workflows in state-affiliated news organisations.
- Newsroom experience informs later research on institutional voice, state-media authority and mediated public communication.

RESEARCH INTERESTS & COLLABORATION

Generative AI and communicative authority; digital intermediation; platform governance; platformed pedagogical authority; AI-mediated education and public services; institutional and platform discourse; critical interface research; Chinese digital and state media; digital health communication; qualitative and critical methods. Interested in collaborative research on AI-mediated services and professional authority alongside doctoral study.